



What's the big deal?

Sit back and enjoy the journey of game engines

The advent of computer technology in the 20th century marked a significant milestone in human history. As the technology continued to evolve, it found its way into various aspects of our lives, and entertainment was no exception. As a result, computer gaming was born. However, what made these games truly immersive and exciting were not the games themselves, but the underlying software that made them possible - the game engines. The history of gaming engines is a fascinating journey through time that showcases the progress and revolution of the gaming industry.

The dawn of game engines: The 1980s

The first notable gaming engine emerged in the 1980s. Bill Budge's Pinball Construction Set (1983), developed for Apple II, is often credited as one of the earliest examples of a gaming engine. Although rudimentary by modern standards, the Pin-

ball Construction Set marked the beginning of a new era. It allowed players to build their own pinball games, providing them with the graphics and physics tools necessary to design the games. This concept, which allowed users to manipulate a game's basic components, laid the groundwork for the contemporary gaming engine.

2D Game Engines: The 1990s

With the advent of the 90s, gaming engines started becoming more sophisticated, encompassing the features we now identify with game engines, such as graphics rendering, sound, AI, and physics simulations. The Wolfenstein 3D engine, developed by id Software in 1992, was one of the first significant developments of this period. Although it was a pseudo-3D engine, it provided a blueprint for more advanced game engines to come. Following Wolfenstein 3D, id Software released the DOOM Engine in 1993,